- ***Distribution of estimates leaning toward smaller numbers and a fairly low average estimate*** —If your tasks are defined well with the intention of delivering small pieces of functionality, this should also be reflected in the team's estimates of the work.
- ***Decreased lead time*** —Delivery of individual tasks measured by lead time should be short.

That will lead you to:

- How long do these tasks really take?
- Are your estimates accurate?

7.3.1. Step 1: explore your data

To figure out if your estimates are accurate, you can start by tracking the size of estimates with estimated distribution and average estimate by the amount of time it takes to get a task all the way through the development process with lead time. You'd expect that tasks that are well defined and broken down into small pieces will be well understood by the development team and as a result should be able to make it through the development process expediently, thus resulting in fast lead times. Using the tools we've been using so far produced the data shown in figure 7.7.

Figure 7.7. The historical estimate distribution and average estimate dashboards for a team